

Plays





About the Course

Students read Shakespeare's plays with additional optional readings and extra helpings from the time period.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 11, Literature: Grade 12, Literature: Grade 9, Literature: Grade 10

Plays: Grades 9-12

William Shakespeare (1564-1616) is perhaps the greatest writer in the English language. Reading and speaking his beautiful words will delight students as they learn his timeless stories, meet a variety of characters, enrich their minds, and instruct their consciences. Students will begin by simply enjoying the plays and later by writing short compositions, comparisons, and commonplace entries. Shakespeare covers the wide panorama of human experience through his nearly 40 plays; the comedies, tragedies, and histories that students read will spark their imaginations with stories that transcend time and culture.



Placement & Combining Tips

This year, this course is the same as Shakespeare for Grades 5-8 with the only difference coming in Extra Helpings and additional options for further study.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9-12	Plays: Grades 9-12 1 time/week 30 min	The Tempest The Tempest (Audio recording) Henry IV Part 2 Henry IV Part 2 (Audio recording) The Winter's Tale The Winter's Tale (Audio recording)

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 9				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 9		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Study: Grade 9	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 10				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 10 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	Poetry Study: Grade 10	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 11				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Plays: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 12				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 11-12	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 Plays: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Plays: Grades 9-12

- ☐ You may want to read "Shakespeare and a Christian Worldview," which is Ch.9 in the book *Echoes of Eden - Reflections on Christianity, Literature, and the Arts* by Jerram Barrs. This is an excellent overview of why Shakespeare is important for everyone to know, including Christians.
- ☐ If your students are new to Shakespeare, read the tips for beginners (Found in Appendix link)
- ☐ You may want to read a retelling beforehand so you are familiar with the play. (Suggestions found in Extra Helpings)
- ☐ Read the discussion questions and skim the summaries of each scene each week before the reading to help guide emphasis and discussion with your students.
- ☐ Consider purchasing puppets to use while reading to keep track of all the characters.

NOTE on VERSIONS

Students should have an unabridged copy that is not in a modern language edition, such as the ones linked in the program. The language complexity gets easier to understand with practice. (Note: Shakespeare's work does often contain bawdy jokes or off-color content that will go over the heads of students if left in its original form; a modern language version will lay it all right out there in plain, modern English.) We like the Folger editions because they are inexpensive, the lines are numbered (making it easy to find your place), and they contain good notes. These are available on the Folger website as free PDFs as well, though the notes are omitted.

NOTE on CONTENT

Teachers are sometimes wary of reading Shakespeare with their students because the plays do contain material that they would deem inappropriate. The Alveary generally follows Mason's programs for younger students. That does not mean, however, that your student will never encounter anything unsavory. Our best advice is to read in such a way that these things are moved over quickly, without added attention being drawn to them. Mason assures us that Shakespeare provides students with rich language and character lessons that are unparalleled.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Plays: Grades 9-12



The Tempest



The Tempest (Audio recording)



Henry IV Part 2



Henry IV Part 2 (Audio recording)



The Winter's Tale



The Winter's Tale (Audio recording)



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Plays: Grades 9-12

∞ [Appendix: Ideas for Students New to Shakespeare](#)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Plays: Grades 9-12

How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.

Plays: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 1		
WEEK 1	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 1	
WEEK 2	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 2	
WEEK 3	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 3	
WEEK 4	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 4	
WEEK 5	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 5	
WEEK 6	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 6	
WEEK 7	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 7	
WEEK 8	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 8	
WEEK 9	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 9	
WEEK 10	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 10	
WEEK 11	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 11	
WEEK 12	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 12	

Plays: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 2	
WEEK 1	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 13
WEEK 2	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 14
WEEK 3	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 15
WEEK 4	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 16
WEEK 5	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 17
WEEK 6	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 18
WEEK 7	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 19
WEEK 8	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 20
WEEK 9	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 21
WEEK 10	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 22
WEEK 11	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 23
WEEK 12	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 24

Plays: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 3		
WEEK 1	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 25	
WEEK 2	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 26	
WEEK 3	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 27	
WEEK 4	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 28	
WEEK 5	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 29	
WEEK 6	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 30	
WEEK 7	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 31	
WEEK 8	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 32	
WEEK 9	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 33	
WEEK 10	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 34	
WEEK 11	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 35	
WEEK 12	 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 36	